

Baha Khammari

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Research Interests

Applied microeconomics, causal inference, labour economics, policy evaluation, development economics.
Methodological focus on difference-in-differences estimation, panel data methods, and heterogeneous treatment effects.

Education

University of Cologne

Cologne, Germany

M.Sc. Economics, 120 ECTS. Thesis 1.0, overall 1.6 (completed Sep. 2026)

Oct. 2023 – Sep. 2026

- Specialisation: Applied Econometrics, Energy Economics, Financial Macroeconomics.
- Relevant coursework: Advanced Econometrics, Causal Inference, Panel Data Analysis, Time Series Econometrics, Microeconomics, Energy Economics.
- Available from Oct. 2026.

Rotterdam School of Management (RSM), Erasmus University

Rotterdam, Netherlands

Erasmus+ Exchange Semester

Sep. 2024 – Dec. 2024

- Coursework in Asset Pricing (CAPM, multi-factor models) and Derivatives Valuation (Black–Scholes, option strategies).

University of Cologne

Cologne, Germany

B.Sc. Economics (Grade: 1.6/1.0, top 5 % of cohort, Dean's List)

Oct. 2019 – Feb. 2023

Research Experience

Master's Thesis

University of Cologne

Grade 1.0/1.0, 30 ECTS. Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Pia Pinger and Anna Person, M.Sc.

Oct. 2025 – Apr. 2026

- **Title:** *How Equal is Equal Opportunity? Gender, Ethnic and Regional Disparities in Labor Market Outcomes of Higher Education Policies in Brazil.*
- **Found a non-monotonic dose–response whose sign naïve TWFE reverses** ($\hat{\beta}_{\text{TWFE}} = -0.65\%$ against a corrected $+3.04\%$ in Low-Dose regions), an empirical illustration of forbidden comparisons (Goodman-Bacon, 2021).
- Estimated the causal labour-market effects of Brazil's ProUni scholarship programme on 558 microregions (2005–2019) using the Callaway & Sant'Anna (2021) heterogeneity-robust staggered DiD estimator with doubly-robust inference.
- Constructed a microregion-level panel linking ProUni administrative records, RAIS formal employer–employee data (~ 5 million observations), and Census demographics via the **basedosdados** BigQuery interface.
- Magnitudes: $+3.04\%$ wage effect in Low-Dose regions (DR estimate, $p < 0.10$), negative Mid-Dose effects coinciding with recession timing, and near-zero High-Dose effects consistent with diminishing returns.
- Heterogeneity analysis: wage gains accrue disproportionately to non-white workers in moderate-exposure markets (consistent with affirmative-action design). Gender asymmetry persists despite majority-female scholarship uptake.
- Robustness: HonestDiD sensitivity analysis (Rambachan & Roth, 2023), age-cohort placebo, Bacon decomposition, alternative dose cutoffs, concurrent-policy controls (FIES, Quota Law).
- Tools: R (`did`, `fixest`, `HonestDiD`, `tidyverse`, `ggplot2`), SQL/BigQuery, L^AT_EX.

Seminar Paper: Housing and the Macroeconomy

University of Cologne

Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Michael Krause and Dong-Ho Kang, PhD | Grade: **1.3**

2024

- **Title:** *From Boom to Bust: The Role of Subprime Mortgage Credit in the 2007 U.S. Housing Crisis.*
- Weighed the income, credit-supply and house-price-expectation explanations of the 2002–2005 subprime expansion against one another, on the within-county ZIP-code comparisons of Mian and Sufi (2009), the housing supply elasticity instrument of Saiz (2010), and the securitisation evidence in Keys et al. (2010) and Adelino et al. (2016).

Bachelor's Thesis

University of Cologne

Supervisor: Univ.-Prof. Dr. Andreas Schabert | Grade: 1.7/1.0

2022 – 2023

- **Title:** *Finanz-Akzelerator* (the financial accelerator).
- Reviewed and synthesised the theoretical literature on financial frictions and macroeconomic amplification, with a focus on the Bernanke–Gertler–Gilchrist (1999) framework.

Technical Skills

- **Programming & Data Analysis:** R (advanced: `did`, `fixest`, `HonestDiD`, `tidyverse`, `ggplot2`), Python (basic), SQL/BigQuery.
- **Econometric Methods:** Difference-in-Differences (incl. staggered adoption, doubly-robust estimation), Instrumental Variables, Panel Data Models, Event Studies, Bacon Decomposition.
- **Tools:** L^AT_EX/Overleaf, Git/GitHub, MS Excel (advanced), Power BI.

Professional Experience

PwC Germany

Düsseldorf, Germany

Intern & Working Student – Assurance Solutions

Mar. 2023 – Jul. 2025

- Worked two consecutive annual audits for the same client, and supported documentation on several smaller engagements.
- Conducted variance analyses and plausibility checks for annual and group audits (HGB/IFRS) of clients with balance sheets exceeding EUR 500 million.
- Audited sustainability disclosures under ISAE 3000 and performed internal control system (IKS) testing.
- Built KPI tracking and financial forecasting in Excel for the engagement team.

Languages

- German (native), Tunisian Arabic (native), English (C1, IELTS Academic 8.0), French (B1, DELF).

Awards & Activities

- **Dean's List**, University of Cologne. Top 5 % of B.Sc. Economics cohort.
- **Interests:** economic geography and modern history. Fashion. Most sports with a ball or an engine, above all football, Formula 1, tennis and the NFL.
- **2nd Prize**, Young Economic Summit (YES!) 2018, national finals. Developed a policy solution on digital trust in online transactions. Organised by ZBW Leibniz Information Centre for Economics under patronage of the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs.
- **DPG Abitur Prize**, Deutsche Physikalische Gesellschaft (2019), awarded for outstanding performance in Physics.